PROJECT WORTH

GROOMING AWARENESS FOR PARENTS

YOU ARE THEIR FIRST PROTECTOR.

EVERY ROLE HAS INFLUENCE

Children look to adults for safety. Your presence, listening, and actions help protect them.

SIGNS TO LOOK FOR IN CHILDREN

- Anxious, moody, or withdrawn
- Over-compliance or eagerness to please
- Sexual knowledge or activity inappropriate for their age
- Self-harm or suicidal ideation
- Aggressiveness or anger

TAKE ACTION. PROTECT THEIR FUTURE.

- Listen calmly and take the child seriously. Let them speak in their own words. Do not ask leading questions.
- Report concerns to your local child abuse hotline.
- Take steps to prevent further concerning contact.
- Ask guidance from law enforcement, child protective services, or court for next steps.
- Connect your child with supportive resources and trusted adults.

Your role is to listen, support, and protect.
Trained professionals determine what happened.

KNOW THE SIGNS

Pay attention when an adult or older person:

- Seeks unusual access
- Creates secrecy
- Gives excessive gifts, attention, or privileges
- Ignores boundaries or rules
- Discourages time with others

BE THEIR SAFE ADULT

Children thrive with at least one safe adult.

- Listen without judgment
- Respect boundaries
- Follow through

REPORT CONCERNS

You do not need proof to report.
Report concerns to your local child abuse hotline.

SEEK TRAINING

Every parent can benefit from learning:

- Grooming and boundary violations
- Safe, communication
- How to support your child
- Where to report
- Access to resources

WHAT HELPS CHILDREN HEAL

These are researched resilience factors:

- At least one caring adult who believes in them
- Safe, stable, and nurturing relationships
- Predictable routines and a sense of safety
- Supportive relationships with family, friends, teachers, or mentors
- Opportunities to express feelings and regain choice and control
- Access to trauma informed care and other supports

A child does not need a perfect response. **They need you.**

Sources: CDC, Harvard Center on the Developing Child, National Child Traumatic Stress Network

RESOURCES FOR PARENTS

IMMEDIATE DANGER
Call 911.

LOCAL CHILD ABUSE HOTLINE
Report concerns to your local child abuse hotline. They are available 24/7.

NATIONAL CHILD TRAUMATIC STRESS NETWORK
Information and resources for parents and caregivers.
nctsn.org

LOCAL SUPPORT
Contact your county child protective services agency, law enforcement, Children's Advocacy Center, pediatrician, or a trauma informed mental health provider.

TOGETHER, WE LIGHT UP THE DARKNESS.

Protecting children is everyone's responsibility.

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